

Source 3 — What is owed, to whom, and in what order

*Advisor directives, publication pipeline, and the sequencing constraint.

Current as of 11 August 2026.*

1. The five directives

Dr. Juan C. Rey's graded feedback on the qualifying manuscript. Verdict: **pass** — *"meets expectations for passing the qualifying examination."** Five things must change before the dissertation.

#	Directive	Where	What it means concretely
1	Expand the theory considerably	Ch. 2	<i>"Discussion is often limited to a single paragraph."</i> Each theory needs multi-paragraph development with real synthesis, not a nod.
2	Reorganise the review construct by construct	Ch. 2	For every construct: how it has been defined , how it has been measured , how it has been related to other variables — all before any hypothesis appears.
3	Fix terminology sequencing	Ch. 2	Say constructs in Chapter 2. Variable roles — independent, dependent, mediator — are introduced only after the conceptual model and hypotheses are formally presented in Chapter 3.
4	Deepen each hypothesis argument	Ch. 3	<i>"The proposed relationships should emerge from a comprehensive synthesis of the literature rather than from relatively brief discussions."</i>
5	Build a comprehensive recruitment strategy before beginning the dissertation	Method	The Chapter 6 recommendations are <i>"an adequate starting point"</i> — they now have to become an operational plan.

Directives 1 through 4 are one instruction in four parts: the chain from literature to hypothesis must be visible and earned. Construct defined → how prior research measured it → how prior research related it → therefore this relationship is predicted → hypothesis. Right now the hypotheses are stated and briefly supported. They need to *fall out* of the review as the obvious conclusion.

2. Directive 5 is sequenced first, by explicit instruction

Recruitment is what broke the qualifying study. It gets solved before more writing happens.

Status: unserved. Four consecutive literature sweeps have produced **zero** studies that successfully recruited auditors or a comparable specialist population. The literature is not helping here, which means the strategy has to be constructed rather than borrowed.

What the strategy has to contain: a population definition that is actually reachable, channels with realistic yield estimates, an IRB amendment if the definition widens, a budget drawn from the recovered panel funds, and a timeline with lead times that reflect how slowly institutional access actually moves.

The widening that preserves the construct: from *U.S. auditors* to **risk, audit, compliance, or controls professionals conducting recurring multi-period reviews.** The anchoring mechanism requires **recurring review**, not the audit job title specifically. This plausibly raises prevalence by one to two orders of magnitude. It requires an IRB amendment, because the approved protocol specifies auditors.

3. Publication pipeline

P1 — the recruitment-feasibility note. Draft written.

Six in One Hundred Thousand: Why Specialist Professional Populations Cannot Be Recruited from General Research Panels. ~3,400 words.

The contribution is procedural: ***enter your screeners into the panel interface, read the eligible count, and compare it to your target before you compare it to your budget.*** Run against this study it returns 20 against a target of 100 — a failure by a factor of fifteen, discoverable for free before any money moved.

The sequencing insight worth internalising: P1 and Directive 5 are the same work. Writing the feasibility note forces the recruitment problem to be solved on paper. Two obligations, one effort. Four items block submission: advisor sign-off including whether he wants co-authorship; platform terms on disclosing eligibility metrics; IRB confirmation that aggregate reporting on $n = 4$ needs no amendment; and reconciling the exact n against the course manuscript's deliberate "four to five" hedge.

P2 — the conceptual extension paper. Not started.

The chain, argued from literature, with a research agenda. Goes after P1, because a negative methodological finding is easier to place and establishes a publication record first.

P3 — the dissertation. Blocked on Directive 5.

4. Where things actually stand

Qualifying examination	Passed , 26 July 2026
Citable publications	None. A passed exam is not a publication.
Chain	v1.1, argued link by link
Recruitment strategy	Not built — blocking everything downstream
P1	Draft v1, four blocking items

5. How AI is permitted to be used in this work

Dr. Rey's standing instruction, from his course-closing announcement: AI belongs in ****brainstorming, organisation, clarity, and grammar**** — supporting, not replacing, scholarly thinking, synthesis, and interpretation. He asked students to review their Turnitin originality *and AI writing* reports, examine flagged passages, and revise so the writing reflects their own voice and reasoning.

The synthesis and the argument are the scholarly contribution and must be the author's own. Any draft assembled with assistance is raw material to be rewritten, not a manuscript to be submitted.

This matters most for the chain in Source 2. That argument has to be **his reasoning** — held because he has tested it, not accepted because a document asserted it.